

There is a growing need in the world today to find cleverer, more cost-efficient means of marketing one's brands and products. From putting cars on billboards to hanging men between tall buildings at crowded city locations, they're trying everything today. It was almost inevitable that the online space would become one of the major channels of these messages.

You see them everywhere—banners, pop-ups, the increasingly popular pop-uppers, and more. And you aren't left alone to do what you will: the biggest target of these marketing gimmicks has been the innocent e-mail Inbox. From replica watches to products that enhance your sexuality to guns, everything that can be sold is being sold... right in the comfort of the Inbox.



If you wanted to buy stocks, you'd go to a broker

Now really, what's the harm if you receive an e-mail or

two in your inbox inviting you to sleep with somebody else's wife? Not much, but the scale of operations of spam these days is just too much to even begin thinking about extra-marital affairs. Research shows that the average Inbox receives on an average of between 35 to 40 spam messages every day! And that's an average estimate. In 2004, the California legislature found that spam cost United States businesses more than \$10 billion! This included loss of productivity as well as the extra equipment, software and manpower required to combat the problem.